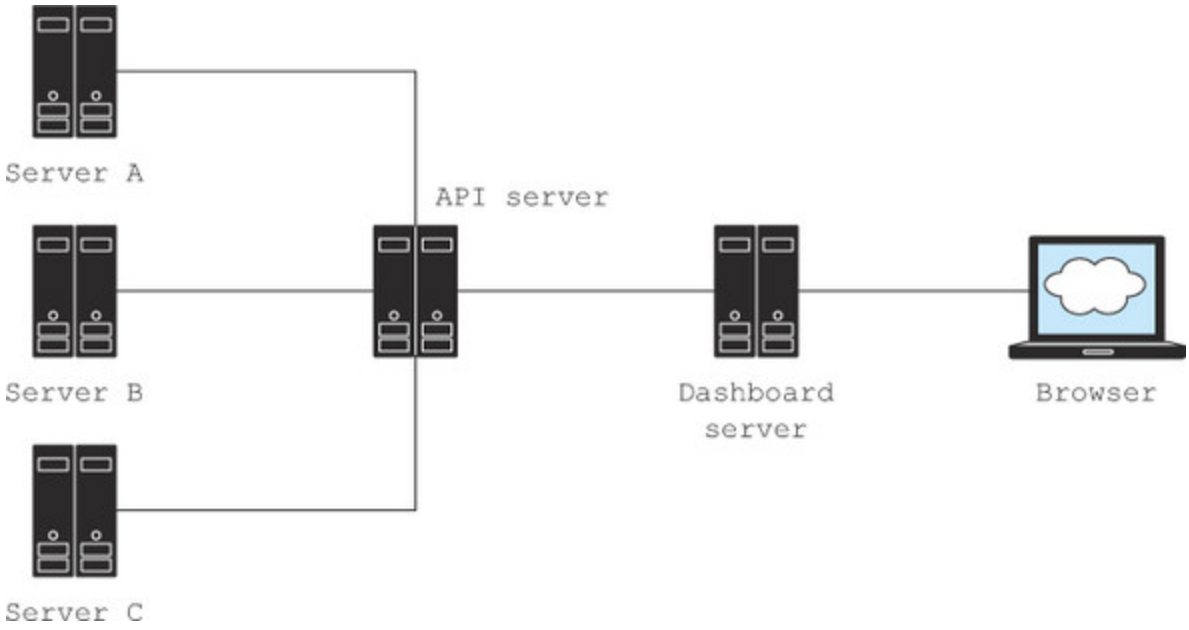
server that collects information from all of the servers he wants to monitor and serves them up for you over HTTP as JSON. Agtron's back-of-the-envelope network diagram is shown in figure 11.2.

Figure 11.2. Agtron's servers



Your CoffeeScript program is entirely browser-based, so you'll need to understand the different techniques for loading data from a server from inside a browser. In this section you'll learn three techniques: `XMLHttpRequest`, dynamic script insertion, and `WebSocket`.

11.2.1. Using XMLHttpRequest

One technique you've seen for fetching data over the web in a browser-based program is to use the `XMLHttpRequest` object (discussed in chapter 5). Here, you wrap it in an `http` function:

```
http = (method, src, callback) ->
  handler = ->
    if @readyState is 4 and @status is 200
      unless @responseText is null
        callback JSON.parse @responseText

  client = new XMLHttpRequest
  client.onreadystatechange = handler
```